



Recall Without Recourse

Surveying whether track labels outlive their own reassignment criteria

Verity Marris · Anneke Tolan — School of Emergent Priorities

Background

Every Master of Priority Studies cohort is sorted into a Foundation or Fast-Track stream from a single day-one diagnostic, framed to students and staff alike as advisory only. Whether that framing survives orientation week has not been examined.

Aims

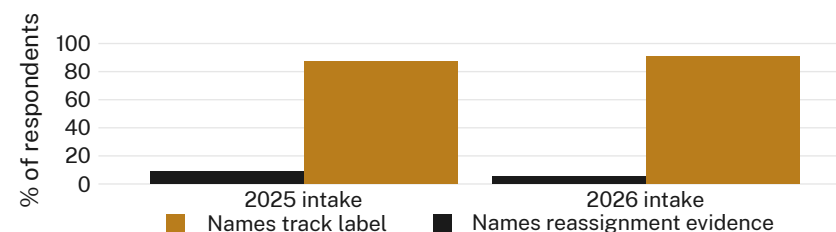
- Test whether the day-one track label persists in self-description after two semesters
- Establish whether students can name the evidence behind their own placement
- Compare recall of the label against recall of the criteria behind it

Methods

- n = 214 · 2025 & 2026 intakes · anonymous online survey · 6-month follow-up
- open-response and closed items on track awareness and reassignment criteria
- diagnostic and advising materials held unchanged across both intakes

Results

89% of respondents named their track unprompted at 6 months; 7% could name any specific evidence that would move them. Recall of the label was stable across cohort and stream; recall of the criteria was not.



Label recall held above 85% in both the 2025 and 2026 intakes; recall of the reassignment evidence fell from 9% to 5% between them.

Discussion & conclusions

The label outlives its own disclaimer. Advising conversations reference the stream routinely and the diagnostic's criteria almost never. Next: a standing re-disclosure of the criteria, timed to the diagnostic itself.

References

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Standing student-experience ethics approval; responses de-identified before analysis; no track reassignments were made as part of this study.

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“Everyone remembers their track.
Almost no one remembers why.”

89% named their day-one track unprompted at 6 months; 7% could name the evidence that would move them off it.